



Snakebird

Snakebird is a lot like snake and is similar in that respect to another game in this list. Whereas 'Through the Fog' converts the idea into high art, 'Snakebird' makes it wacky and adorable. Snakebird is a game about a very peculiar creature. This sedentary creature has a beak but its wings are useless and its primary method of movement is slithering about like a reptile. The game has bright, cartoony design and is reminiscent of children's picturebook.

The aim is to guide the sluggish snakebird around the level to eat the

fruits scattered around it and finally head to a fantastical, rainbow-coloured portal. The fruits make the snake longer and this means that you have to sometimes plan the order in which to go after the fruits. There are spikes and other dangerous things and if your snakebird touches one, it will simply disappear into a cloud of smoke.

The game has some pretty engaging puzzles in each level and requires you to think before making the next move. Do not be fooled by how charming this game looks, it will test your logic a bit. However, if you make a wrong move, you can always undo the last move or simply start over. There is



no limit on the resets you can make like in some other games of this sort. There is also a gridview which will help you figure out exactly what alignment the snakebird is going to be in after each move. There are no ads and no complications regarding in-game currency or other incentives popularly employed to keep the player returning to the game.

Dunkers

Dunkers is a pixelated little game about dunking. It is uncomplicated and immensely easy to pick up which is a large part of its appeal. There is not much variation in terms of gameplay and in that respect it is quite like 'Drive Ahead', a simple game about driving on the other player's head. It focuses on providing you a streamlined, arcade experience without many frills and this makes it very easy to pick up and play any time you want to procrastinate just a little bit more.

In Dunkers, you control a tiny pixelated woman, monkey or ninja and guide them across the court to dunk in their hoop. The physics are the most amusing part of this game



and dunking is easier written about than done. The movements of the characters are unpredictable in the best way. There is an arcade mode where you are pitched against a random opponent from within the game. The best part however, is the two player mode. Just like Drive Ahead, Dunkers is a perfect couch multiplayer and offers countless hours spent trying to beat your annoying sibling or friend. Get dunking already.

Tinker Island

Tinker Island is a fascinating blend of a text-based RPG and a card game about trying to make it in the wilderness. The story is that the characters in the game have been stranded on a remote island in the mid-

dle of nowhere and must now explore the island and survive until they can make their escape. The game brings to mind the book 'The Mysterious Island' by Jules Verne because of how you are supposed to solve certain puzzles and make decisions about what to do with the resources you collect. For those who have not come across this piece of Verne's work, it is essentially a guide combining lessons in alchemy, biology, construction, hunting, mining and a host of other skills which will make you a worthy contender to Bear Grylls.

There are several decisions to be taken at every step in the game. For example, on coming across a pile of rocks that you can kick or examine, you'll discover another survivor who lost

a bit of his health because you kicked him. The interface is neat and the map is displayed on a tab on top whereas resources appear to the sides. The main camp is the backdrop and the different things you create will be shown in this area. To send your survivors to a resource or a particular location on the map, you simply have to drag their card there and wait for a certain time. The missions are time-based and thus will have you returning to check-in on the game quite often.

The graphics are brilliant and even though they are pixelated, it is the best kind of pixelated there is which somehow manages to fit in plenty of details as well. Tinker Island is like a better version of 'Virtual Villagers'.

